

What the leaders display on a listing — and the quarter of it that transfers

Most of this library solves a problem we deliberately refuse: finding the house. The host already found it. What transfers is everything that happens after — how a listing is carried as a card, how a price states its own scope, how three candidates are put beside each other, and how absence is drawn when the data never arrived.

SOURCE

Mobbin iOS — 10 apps

APPS

Airbnb · Booking.com · Vrbo · Expedia · Trip.com · Agoda · Skyscanner · Tripadvisor · Zillow

HANDS-ON

None — read off captured screens

OUR SIDE

The return-trip ruling, 28 July

Scope first — most of this library is for a job we do not do

Our ruling stands: **the app never searches Airbnb or Vrbo**. The host already found the house. Our job is the *return trip* — turning a pasted results page or an unfurled listing into a decision, a cost, and a backup. `LodgingSearchLinks` hands off to the platforms, and that is the right call.

PATTERN	TRANSFERS?	WHY
Card anatomy	Directly	<code>candidatesFromGroups</code> output renders as cards
Price display semantics	Directly — the biggest one	We already take the <i>last</i> price off a strike-through pair
Comparison surfaces	Directly	Our shortlist <i>is</i> a comparison
Missing-data rendering	Directly	Vrbo unfurl declines from a datacenter IP — candidates will arrive thin
Post-booking view	Yes	Closest analogue to our committed pick

PATTERN	TRANSFERS?	WHY
Search, filters, map, sort	No	We hand off
Scarcity & urgency	Reject	See below
What was read for, and what was deliberately ignored.		

Card anatomy — the field census

Every card in the set, decomposed. This is the checklist for what a candidate row can carry.

FIELD	AIRBNB	VRBO	BOOKING.COM	TRIP.COM
Badge on artwork	Guest favorite pill	—	—	—
Title	"Apartment in San Juan" — type + place	long descriptive name	property name	property name
Distance	—	"1.97 mi from Bangkok City Centre"	"Near Pham Ngu Lao"	"Near Tan Son Nhat Airport"
Capacity	—	"Condo · Sleeps 16 · 4 bedrooms"	"2 beds · 1 bedroom · 1 bathroom"	—
Rating	★4.84 inline with price	—	9.1 Wonderful · 74 reviews	4.1/5 Very Good · 20 reviews
Cancellation	—	Free cancellation until Sep 17	—	Free Cancellation
Price	"\$126 for 2 nights"	\$16,800 + \$20,529 total	"Per night \$102" · "2 nights: \$276 \$204"	\$17 + "Total (incl. taxes & fees): \$19"

FIELD	AIRBNB	VRBO	BOOKING.COM	TRIP.COM
Urgency	—	—	"Only 1 left at this price"	—

Read off search-result cards, 1 August 2026. Empty means the app does not show that field on the card — not that the data is absent from the product.

The title is a type and a place

Take

Airbnb's card reads "Apartment in San Juan", "Room in Southeast Washington". The listing's own marketing headline is demoted to the detail page.

A gift for us: an unfurled listing's title is often junk. "House in McHenry" derived from type + city is cheaper to extract *and* more scannable than whatever the host pasted.

Only Vrbo puts capacity on the card

Note, don't copy

Sleeps 16 · 4 bedrooms — exactly our must-have axis.

But it says *Sleeps*, and our own scar is that **beds is never written as sleeps** — "8 beds" is not "sleeps 8". Vrbo collapses two concepts into one number. We must not.

Price display — the honesty problem, and the best answer in the library

Nobody shows one price. Every app shows at least two of {per night, total, total incl. fees}, always as small-label-plus-large-number.

APP	WHAT IT SHOWS	READ
Agoda	A first-run coachmark offering three modes: Base per night / Total stay include taxes and fees / Average per night — the user picks the semantics	★ Best in library
Airbnb	\$126 for 2 nights — one number, scope in the label	Cheapest honest answer
Vrbo	\$4,000 large, \$4,539 total underlined beneath	Both visible

APP	WHAT IT SHOWS	READ
Trip.com	\$17 large, "Total (incl. taxes & fees): \$19" small	Both visible
Booking.com	"Per night \$102" then "2 nights: \$276 \$204 "	Honest, three numbers
Expedia	\$2,073 \$1,731 + "includes taxes & fees" + "\$302 per night"	Three numbers + a discount claim
Skyscanner	\$268 a night + provider logo + "More deals from \$348"	Aggregator — price belongs to a seller
Ranked by how clearly the number states its own scope.		

Agoda's move is the one to steal

Adopt

A coachmark on first run lets the user choose what a price *means* for the rest of the session. It converts an unresolvable design argument — nightly or total? — into a stated user preference.

WHY IT FITS	That is propose-don't-ask applied to a <i>unit</i> . And the ambiguity is genuinely real for us: a destination event spans nights, so neither number is obviously correct.
CHEAPER OPTION	Airbnb's, if we want no setting at all — put the scope in the sentence and the second line disappears.

Direct hit on our parser

Confirms a measured fact

Booking.com, Expedia and Trip.com *all* render ~~struck~~ then payable.

Our measured page fact — "*price is \$1,997 ~~\$1,668~~ (strike-through, then payable) → **take the LAST***" — is confirmed across three more platforms, not just Airbnb. Worth locking in a test.

Comparison surfaces — this is our shortlist

Three real comparison UIs exist in the library, and they resolve the same problem two different ways. The minority answer is the one that fits us.

Vrbo — "Compare stays"

Expedia — "Compare"

Card columns

Three columns, horizontally scrollable.
Photo · name · type icon (Villa /
Aparthotel) · 2 bedrooms / 2
bathrooms / Sleeps 4 · review chip ·
date range · price + total · then ✓ / ✕
amenity rows · View .

★ COPY THIS

No review score renders as — — not blank, not zero. Explicit absence.

★ AND THIS

✓ is green, ✕ is **grey, not red**. A missing hot tub is not an error. Under UX_02, red would be a semantic lie.

Card columns

Two columns, denser. Star rating,
neighbourhood, 8.8/10 Excellent ·
442 reviews , bed config, a scarcity line,
the struck price pair, "includes taxes &
fees", "\$302 per night", then ✓ / ✕ rows.

Same skeleton as Vrbo with more rows —
and it inherits the same flaw below.

Zillow transposes it — and that is the model for us

★ Highest-value item here

Properties become **columns**; attributes become **labelled rows** down a sticky left rail — Status, List Price, Zestimate, Estimated monthly cost, Price/sqft, Bedrooms, Bathrooms, Square feet — with grouped section headers (Interior) breaking the rail into sections.

	Lake house	The barn	Cabin 4
MUST-HAVES			
REAL BEDS	8	6	—
SLEEPS	11	10	8
DRIVE TO VENUE	12 min	25 min	9 min
MONEY			
NIGHTLY	\$412	\$380	\$355
TOTAL, 3 NIGHTS	\$1,394	\$1,290	—
STANDING			
STATUS	Committed	Backup	Unpriced

WHY OURS

Our comparison axis is **must-haves** — a finite, known, named list. A labelled rail makes a missing value show up as a *gap in a known row*. Card columns hide a missing attribute by simply not rendering it.

LIVE CASE

Vrbo unfurl declines from a datacenter IP, so some candidates *will* arrive thin. The rail is the layout that makes that visible instead of invisible.

HotelTonight — the card that does the most with the least

The strongest single listing component in the library, and the only one that is **dark-native** — so its composition transfers to Studio Matte without translation.

1 room left

♡

full-bleed photo

SOLID

DEAL

Hilton Garden Inn Times Square

\$189

👍 91% | 0.5 km - Times Square

was on HT \$210

Free WiFi

24h Gym

Reconstructed from the captured screens — layout and hierarchy are theirs, the rendering is ours.

The taste taxonomy is categorical, not ordinal

★ Take

BASIC · SOLID · HIP · LUXE · HIGHROLLER — each its own colour. **HIP is not better than SOLID, it is different.** It answers "what kind of place is this?" in one word, which a star rating can never do.

FITS US

Our event types already use identification colour at low intensity that does *not* count

The struck price is their own history

★ Take

was on HT \$210 means *we listed this at \$210 before* — a checkable claim about themselves, not an unverifiable claim about the market. Compare Expedia's ~~\$2,073~~ **\$1,731**, which asserts a reference price nobody can audit.

OURS

"was \$412 when you saved it" — honest, checkable, and genuinely useful when a host

against the semantic budget (UX_02's `evtCLR` exception). A lodging *character* badge — `house` · `cabin` · `hotel` · `condo` — is the same class of signal and inherits the same exemption.

returns to a shortlist built three weeks ago.

The rating is a percentage, not stars

Take

👍 91% . One number, no half-symbols to render, no 4.63-versus-4.84 false precision. Scans instantly at card size.

Why these hotels?

Take the principle

A plain button at the foot of the list. **The curation explains itself on demand.** We rank candidates by must-have fit and currently never say so.

The composition lesson: the photo does the emotional work; the info strip is a flat dark band with **zero decoration** — no borders, no shadows, no rounded chips except the badges. Name and price share one baseline; metadata sits muted beneath. Exactly the division of labour UX_01 already mandates, executed on a dark ground.

Hotels are a different object from rentals

Our lodging model assumes **one property = one booking**. Hotels break that — and a destination event with eleven people is far more likely to need rooms than a whole house.

CONCEPT	WHOLE-HOUSE RENTAL	HOTEL
The unit	the property	a room type within the property
Price attaches to	the property	a rate plan within the room type
Quantity	always 1	N rooms — the block. We have no primitive for this
Capacity	<code>Sleeps 16</code>	<i>per room:</i> "guaranteed to fit 2 people"
Cancellation	one policy	per rate plan
<i>The shape mismatch, stated plainly.</i>		

Booking.com nests three levels

property → room type → rate plan. Each room type carries bed config, size in m², and an amenity checklist. Beneath it, *selectable rate cards* with a radio control, each stating **Free cancellation before Mar 18 · No prepayment needed – pay at the property** · price. Quantity is a 1 unit ▾ dropdown with a delete affordance.

THE GAP

That dropdown **is** the room block, and it is the primitive we lack entirely.

★ BEST
PATTERN

When a room type cannot hold the party, it renders as a **disabled card reading "These options won't accommodate your entire group"** — visible, self-explaining, unselectable. Exactly the behaviour we want when a candidate fails a head-count must-have.

HotelTonight states capacity as a guarantee *with an exception*

Steal the sentence

"Rate displayed is per night, per room. Each room is guaranteed to fit 2 people. Extra guests are at the hotel's discretion and may be subject to additional fees."

That sentence names **the unit, the guarantee, and who decides the edge case**. Our `beds` ≠ `sleeps` rule is the same instinct — this is how it gets expressed to a host.

What we would need: a hotel candidate cannot be stored in the current shape. Minimum additions — `roomType`, `ratePlan`, `unitsNeeded`, `perRoomCapacity`, and a cancellation policy hanging off the rate rather than the property. **Scope before building** — this is a schema change, and it interacts with the per-day programme keystone.

Honesty patterns from the hotel set

Three moves stronger than anything in the rental apps.

"We do not verify reviews."

★ Our doctrine, shipped by someone else

HotelTonight prints this in its `Need to Know` list.

A platform stating the limit of its own social proof is rare — and it is precisely our rule: say what you do not know, in place, without being asked.

Negative amenities as a first-class list

★ Highest-value in this section

A whole card of what the hotel *lacks*, each with a struck-through icon: No fitness center. No pets. No minibar. No food or beverage options at the hotel. No bar onsite. No breakfast available.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every other app shows only what a place *has*, leaving absence to inference. For a host checking must-haves this inverts the work: instead of scanning 55 amenities to confirm something is missing, **the absence is stated**.

CONNECTS TO This is the strongest argument for the Zillow-transpose shortlist above — same principle, applied to comparison.

Priced amenities carry their price

Money hides here

Valet parking \$65/night. · No self-parking. · Dogs OK under 40 lbs, \$150 flat fee. · Service fee of \$35 per night per room collected by hotel.

An amenity is not a boolean when it costs money. A \$35/night/room service fee across four rooms for three nights is **\$420 that never appears in the headline price**.

Need to Know as plain bullets

Check-in 15:00, checkout 12:00, photo ID and credit card required, 21+ to book, non-smoking. No legalese, no accordion.

The hotel equivalent of our day-before plan, and the register is right — flat declarative sentences about what will actually happen.

One commit gesture worth noting

The final booking step is "**Trace the Logo to complete your booking**" — a gesture, not a tap, drawn over the HT bed glyph.

Same family as Blink's swipe-to-clock-in: friction proportional to irreversibility. We already have a `commit` haptic and a `seal` verb in the 17-verb vocabulary; the gesture is the visual half we have not built.

The detail page — Airbnb's section order

Read across the captured screens, in order. A sticky bottom bar persists throughout: `$356` underlined · "For 2 nights · Sep 5–7" · ✓ **Free cancellation** · `Reserve` .

1. **Photo carousel** with a `2/27` counter

2. **Title**, then `Room in New York, United States` and `1 queen bed · Shared bathroom`

3. **Three-up stat row**, divider-separated: 4.96 ★ | Guest favorite | 298 Reviews
4. **Host row** — avatar, "Stay with Allison", Superhost · 7 years hosting
5. **"Where you'll sleep"** — a card per sleeping area with its bed config
6. **"What this place offers"** — icon + label list, then Show all 55 amenities
7. **"Where you'll be"** — map, neighbourhood named
8. **"About this place"** — prose, Show more
9. **Cancellation / House rules / Safety & property** — short lists, each with Show more
10. **Reviews** — big 4.96 between laurels, "top 5% of eligible listings"

Provenance on translated text

We have this gap

"Some info has been automatically translated. [Show original](#)"

A machine touched this text and the page says so, with a route back to the source. That is our own grounding doctrine applied to a listing description — and **our unfurl parses, normalises and infers, and says nothing**. The same gap we just criticised Blink for.

Amenities are icon + label, never chips

Already our rule

Five to seven visible, the rest behind a count. No chip soup.

Matches our three-chips-per-row rule. Confirmatory, not corrective.

The return trip — the closest screen to our committed pick

Airbnb's **reservation view** is what a listing becomes *after* it is decided.

- In 3 months chip over the photo — **relative time, not a date**
- Home in New York / Hosted by Allison
- A two-column card: **Check-in** Fri, Sep 5 · 7:00 PM | **Checkout** Sat, Sep 6 · 1:00 PM
- Then action rows, icon + title + subtitle: Getting there / 311 East 91 Street · House manual / Instructions and house rules · Message your host / Allison

The entire marketing apparatus is gone. No rating, no reviews, no price, no amenities, no scarcity. Once the decision is made the surface holds only *what you need to arrive and*

behave.

A strong argument that our committed pick should be a **different composition**, not the candidate card with a checkmark on it — which lines up exactly with the gap board's finding that the leaders promote state to a named surface while we carry it as a parameter.

What to reject

The library is saturated with pressure devices that are correct for a marketplace and wrong for us.

- Rare find! This place is usually booked — Airbnb, pinned above the sticky bar on every scroll
- Only 1 left at this price on Booking.com — red
- We have 5 left at 17% off — Expedia
- It only takes 2 minutes — Booking.com, a yellow interstitial band
- \$169 off · Genius Discount · Silver Tier Deal 38% Off · New Guest Offer

None of it transfers. These move inventory the platform sells. We sell nothing, hold no inventory, and a host deciding where eleven people sleep is not a shopper to be hurried. Under UX_02 every one would spend `--warn` or `--crit` on a commercial nudge rather than an operational state — **precisely the amber-"now" trap the gap board already caught us in.**

The one shape worth keeping

Honest degradation

Booking.com renders an unusable option as a **disabled card reading "These options won't accommodate your entire group"** — it stays visible, explains itself, and cannot be selected.

Not pressure. That is exactly how a candidate failing a must-have should read: present, self-explaining, unpickable.

Recommendations

Ranked by how much each closes a real gap in what we already ship.

1. **Adopt the Zillow transpose for the shortlist.** Named attribute rows down a left rail, candidates as columns. Missing data becomes a visible gap in a known row. Highest value here, because our axis is a finite must-have list.
2. **Render absence as —** — never blank, never zero. Vrbo does this on review score; we have a live case in the declining Vrbo unfurl.
3. **Show two prices, or state the scope in the sentence.** Vrbo's `$4,000 / $4,539 total`, or Airbnb's `$126 for 2 nights`. **Never one bare number.**
4. **Consider Agoda's price-mode choice** for the destination case, where nightly-versus-total is genuinely ambiguous across a span.
5. **Mark what the unfurl derived.** Airbnb marks machine-translated text and offers the original. Ours infers silently.
6. **Give the committed pick its own composition**, not the candidate card in a "chosen" state.
7. **Green ✓, grey ✕ — never red** for a missing amenity. Disqualifying is not faulty.
8. **Ship none of the scarcity vocabulary.**

Sources: Mobbin iOS app pages and flows for Airbnb, Booking.com, Vrbo, Expedia, Trip.com, Agoda, Skyscanner, Tripadvisor, Zillow and KakaoTalk, read 1 August 2026.

Not claimed: no pricing accuracy, no A/B or usage data, no exact type sizes — Mobbin re-renders at roughly a third of native width — and no hands-on with any of these products. Everything above is read off captured screens. Where a card omits a field, that means the app does not show it on the card, not that the product lacks the data.

Our-side claims — the return-trip ruling, `beds` ≠ `sleeps`, and take-the-last-price — are prior measured facts from the 28 July lodging session, not new findings. Companion to the Mobbin Competitive Read gap board, whose lodging section covers architecture rather than pixels. Rendered in Studio Matte, single-theme by decision.